The 6:15

SATURDAY · OCTOBER 31, 2026 NO. 33

THE BOARD

CALENDAR · WEEKEND FORMAT

Today	Northwestern at Oregon, Eugene — first-ever meeting, 3:30p ET, Peacock; Oregon favored ~3.5 (BetMGM/Action Network). OPEC+ meets; Nov. output already set flat at 31.01M bpd per the Oct. 4 decision, no change expected before 2027.
Next 10 days	Tue 11/3 midterm elections — House/Senate majorities in play. Fri 11/6 October jobs report (NFP), 8:30a ET.

No frontier AI release or major rocket launch confirmed this run. October's largest new VC round (Tenstorrent's $1.5B Series E, Oct. 19) is prior-issue continuity, not repeated here.

METRICS · FRIDAY CLOSE, WEEKEND FORMAT

Equities	A historic rout: S&P 500 -1.82% to 7,580.07; Nasdaq Comp. -2.86% to 25,437.00, worst day since June 5; Dow -1.09% to 51,770.31; VIX +12.91% to 19.42. October closed Nasdaq's worst month since March 2025 (-5.2%/-5.3%); S&P -1.2% for the month; Dow +1.5%.
Oil / rates / other	Brent $113.43 (+2.37%) / WTI $104.12 (+2.08%), oilprice.com — spread ~$9.31, narrower than Oct. 24's ~$13.45; Investing.com's feed runs ~$1 higher, **unreconciled**. 10Y 4.929% (-~6bp); 2Y/30Y **not confirmed this run**. Gold $3,899 (-3.29%) — one outlet's headline calls it a one-year low, **not confirmed in body text**. DXY **not confirmed**. Gas $4.1837/gal, a sixth straight decline.

HORMUZ COUNTERS · STRAITS.LIVE, 31 OCT 1018Z (6:18A ET)

Status	Closed to commercial shipping, Day 244
Transits	Still 2 vessels, Oct. 25 (PortWatch) vs. 85/day baseline — unrevised, 6 days stale
Dark tankers	78 of 145 screened, 24h (53.8%); no 7-day avg. given this run **(non-tankers also went dark at a**

	similar 44.8% clip)
War-risk premium	~32x pre-crisis, dated Oct. 7 — 24 days stale, background only
Indices	Crisis Pressure 88±9 (Extreme, flat); Escalation Forecast 60±11 (High, -1)
Market odds	Polymarket, unchanged: 6% normal transit by 11/30, 12% by 12/31

Methodology: IRGC claims (Iranian state media), UKMTO (no advisory this period), PortWatch (lagged AIS transit count) and straits.live's AIS dark-tanker screen (dropout-sensitive, now showing non-tankers dark at a similar rate) measure different things over different windows — never averaged or differenced here.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Season over — eliminated Oct. 7, swept 3-0 by Tampa Bay.
Knicks	Lost 98-93 at Philadelphia Fri. night. Record **not printed this run** — sources disagree and don't reconcile against a single loss.
Northwestern	Travels to Oregon today for the programs' first-ever meeting.

LEAD

AI CAPEX RECKONING

Intel's worst day since 1974, a capex-driven Amazon stumble and a Reddit miss drag the Nasdaq to its worst month since March — even after Thursday's GDP print beat

Thursday's data, briefly, because Friday ran it over: the BEA's advance estimate put Q3 GDP growth at 3.4% annualized, above the roughly 3.2% consensus and faster than Q2's 2.2%, with the PCE price index inside the same report showing inflation slowing to 2.1%. Initial jobless claims for the week ended Oct. 24 fell to 194,000, a three-month low and below both a Reuters-cited 199,000 estimate and a separately reported Dow Jones forecast of 200,000,

with the four-week average easing to 196,750. Both resolve items this brief flagged as still-unreleased in issue No. 32; both were, on their own terms, good news for an economy the Fed just told markets it isn't in a hurry to ease for.

Friday erased that signal. Intel reported Thursday after the close with a Q3 that beat on both lines it's measured on — $16.5 billion revenue, $0.52 adjusted EPS, against a $17.1 billion/$0.43 analyst consensus (LSEG) — with data-center and AI revenue up 78% even as client (PC) revenue fell 5%. The stock didn't move on that print. It moved on the guide: Q4 revenue of $15.0-16.0 billion against this quarter's own $16.5 billion actual, and adjusted gross margin collapsing to a guided 38.0% from 44.1%, with management citing a PC memory-chip shortage pushing prices up and demand down. Shares fell 28.58% Friday, closing at $65.76 — Intel's worst single-session decline since 1974, by multiple outlets' count.

Amazon compounded it rather than offsetting it. AWS revenue rose roughly 39% to about $46 billion, its fastest growth in nearly five years, with Andy Jassy guiding to AWS growth exceeding 40% in both 2027 and 2028 — but consolidated EPS of $1.89 missed a consensus clustered around $1.96-1.97, revenue of $201.94 billion landed just under a roughly $202.2 billion estimate, and trailing-12-month free cash flow was negative $42.4 billion against quarterly capex near $77 billion. Reports of the after-hours move itself ranged from roughly 6% to 11% depending on source and timestamp, a spread wide enough that this brief won't print one figure as the move. Reddit added a third leg: shares fell roughly 24%-29% (sources disagree) on weaker-than-expected daily active users, soft Q4 revenue guidance, and a plan to require login for forum access.

Read: this is the Microsoft-vs.-Alphabet capex-discipline split this brief has tracked since Wednesday's earnings, now widening past the two hyperscalers it started with. Intel's crash wasn't about AI demand — data-center/AI revenue grew 78% — it was about the gross margin the company itself says that demand now costs to serve, the same mechanism investors punished in Alphabet's capex guide last week. Amazon's AWS growth was arguably the best print of the week on a pure-growth basis, and the market sold it anyway because $77 billion in one quarter's capex and a ninth straight quarter of negative trailing free cash flow reads, to a market already primed by Wednesday and Thursday, as the same story with a new ticker. Reddit's miss is a separate, company-specific thread — DAUs and a login-wall plan, not capex — but it hit the same tape and widened the day's losses. Watch: whether Monday's open (Nov. 2) extends Friday's rout or treats it as a one-day flush; the first market reaction to a six-day-old 31%-32% Reuters/Ipsos approval reading four days before the midterms; and Tuesday's election itself, which the Fed's Wednesday hold and hawkish dissent axis now sit directly upstream of.

IRAN & HORMUZ

Little moved beyond the Board's numbers. straits.live's dark-tanker screen read 78 of 145 vessels (53.8%) over the past 24 hours, but the tracker didn't publish a 7-day average for comparison this run and separately noted non-tanker traffic went dark at a similar 44.8% clip — this brief reads that as evidence the screen is picking up ambient AIS dropout across all vessel types this period, not a tanker-specific evasion signal, consistent with the same caveat flagged in issue No. 30. PortWatch's transit count remains frozen at 2 vessels on Oct. 25 against the 85/day baseline, now six days unrevised — the longest

stretch without an update this brief has carried. The composite indices ticked in opposite directions by a single point apiece: Crisis Pressure flat at 88 (Extreme), Escalation Forecast down one to 60 (High). No new IRGC claim, UKMTO advisory, or diplomatic statement surfaced in this run's research beyond what prior issues have already carried; Araghchi's reopening offer remains unanswered.

SPORTS

Yankees	Season over; eliminated Oct. 7, swept 3-0 by Tampa Bay in the ALDS.
Knicks	Lost 98-93 at Philadelphia Fri. night — Maxey 27 and LeBron James 20 led the Sixers; Brunson 24 and a Towns double-double for New York. Record not confirmed this run.
Northwestern	Travels to Oregon today, 3:30p ET, Peacock — first-ever meeting between the programs; Oregon favored by ~3.5. Result after press time.

Continuity. Politics, Economics and Business stay folded into the Lead this weekend issue rather than carrying separate sections — Thursday's GDP/claims prints and Friday's earnings-driven rout are this week's whole economic and market story, and nothing else broke. Technology is likewise covered in the Lead (Intel, Amazon, Reddit) rather than repeated. Watch for next issue: Monday's market open and whether Friday's selloff extends or reverses; the Knicks' actual record, which this brief declined to estimate; Tuesday's midterm results; and whether straits.live republishes a 7-day dark-tanker average.

Unverified figures are marked in red: the Knicks' current win-loss record; Amazon's exact after-hours stock move (6%-11% depending on source); Reddit's exact stock decline (24%-29%); DXY and 2Y/30Y Treasury closes; the "one-year low" characterization of Friday's gold price; the Brent-WTI spread's precise level (oilprice.com vs. Investing.com diverge by ~$1); Northwestern's AP ranking (No. 20 vs. No. 24 depending on source, omitted from this issue rather than guessed). Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.